



Social Psychology (SOCPSY)

Module 5: Helping and Attraction

Attraction and Relationships

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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Factors in Attraction

Reliable factors include proximity and mere exposure (repeated contact increases liking), similarity of attitudes and values, physical attractiveness (strong in first impressions through the halo effect), and reciprocity (we like those who like us).

Campus Patterns

Hostel neighbours often become friends partly because of proximity. Shared course interests build similarity. A classmate who shows genuine interest can trigger reciprocity. These factors explain first patterns of liking; they do not guarantee healthy relationships.

Love in Simple Terms

Sternberg's simple map uses three components: intimacy (closeness), passion (attraction and excitement), and commitment (decision to stay). Different mixes create different relationship types. Consummate love combines all three. Use the map as a tool for understanding, not as a rigid rule.

Reflect: Which factor has mattered most in a friendship or relationship you know: proximity, similarity, or reciprocity?

Closing

Module 5 covered helping and attraction. Module 6 addresses attitudes, conformity, and obedience.